



Concordia Intramural Soccer League Rules (CISL)

Updated November 2024

For any league-related questions, please email camprec@concordia.ca

Please note that occasionally, games may be re-scheduled outside of the normal league time frame due to Stinger game and event obligations.

1.0 General League rules

1.1 The Concordia Intramural Soccer League (CISL) is open to students, staff, faculty, alumni and the public. Current season varsity soccer players are not permitted to participate in the league.

1.2. The spirit of the league is to provide its participants with a positive recreational experience incorporating a high spirit of sportsmanship, fair play, and mutual respect between players.

1.3 The league is co-ed.

1.4 All players must be fully REGISTERED to participate in the league. Once the team captain has registered the team into the league, individual team members must complete their registration before the registration deadline. Team captains agree to have their names and email addresses shared with other team captains for ease of communication.

1.5 The game is played with each side fielding six players and a keeper (7v7).

1.6 All team members are required to wear similar colored jerseys with numbers. Jerseys are the responsibility of the team, and not the Department of Recreation and Athletics. Teams must also have an alternate color/pinnies in the case where teams have the same-coloured jersey. Away teams are responsible for changing their jersey color if the Home team has a similar colored jersey.

1.7 Team captains must complete the game sheet prior to the start of the game. Team captains are the only players who can consult with game officials.

1.8 When a team is aware they will default/forfeit a game, the captain must inform, in writing, the League (camprec@concordia.ca), as well as the captain of the opposing team, two days or more in advance. Teams that forfeit a game within two days, will be charged \$80 to be paid prior to their next game as well as lose that game 3-0.

1.9 To avoid a default, teams must field at least five players no later than 15 minutes past the scheduled start time.

1.10 Captains/team members are not permitted to write to the league with complaints until 24+ hours following the game in question. This will be referred to as the 'cooling off period'.

1.11 The Department of Recreation and Athletics reserves the right to request that a team change their team's name if it is deemed inappropriate.

1.12 Teams rosters must consist of a maximum of **12** players (including goalies). Teams can add additional players to their rosters online before the deadline, but they will need to pay an additional fee per player to exceed the maximum.

1.13 Refunds: Full refunds are granted within seven days of registration and payment. Exception: Captains will not be refunded their registration fee if a team withdraws from a sport league, whether from voluntary withdrawal or through administrative decision(s) involving suspension or expulsion.

2.0 Soccer League Rules

2.1 Spare players are allowed and can be determined from each team individually, there is no fee to the league. However, a spare player must be added to the gamesheet (We will verify an ID), and they can only be added if they are replacing a registered roster player.

2.2 A delay-of-game penalty will be assessed to any team that delays the start of a game. This penalty will be given 60 seconds after the time allotted for warm-up has expired.

2.3 At any time during the course of play, if a team falls below the required five players for any reason, then an automatic default will be awarded to the guilty team regardless of the score. This also applies to failing to place the required number of players on the field.

2.4 Any defaulted game or game ended prematurely will not be rescheduled unless authorized by the league.

2.5 Any teams incurring five or more defaults without the required notification (see 1.8-1.9) will not be eligible for playoffs.

2.6 No player can join the game past half time.

3.0 Equipment

3.1 Teams are responsible for their own jerseys or pinnies with numbers. All players on one team are required to wear similar colors. Team colours will be determined at the start of the season. Away team will be responsible for bringing pinnie; home team will be responsible for bringing the soccer ball. Concordia Recreation and Athletics is not responsible for providing equipment or uniforms.

3.2 Goalkeepers must wear a shirt or pinnie that is different from both teams and the referee. They may wear shorts or pants.

3.3 All players must wear running or soccer shoes. Metal cleats will not be accepted, nor sandals or "hiking" boots. Players must be properly attired when playing (shorts, jogging pants, etc. NO JEANS).

3.4 In addition, all players are encouraged to wear shin pads. This is done for the safety of the players.

3.5 Players must not use equipment or wear anything that is dangerous (as per IFAB Law 4) including but not limited to jewelry or watches. Approved sports glasses or goggles are the only eyewear permitted. Hearing aids are also permitted.

*To deter theft, please ensure that all players' personal belongings are grouped together and that players' keep watch on their equipment during matches.

*Please note that bicycles are NOT allowed inside the perimeter fence surrounding the playing fields. Bicycle stands are available next to the entrance gates.

4.0 Match Rules

The CISL follows the International Football Association Board (IFAB) Laws of the Game for match rules during all games (unless otherwise specified in previous or following sections) beside, some house rules drawn from various soccer leagues. It is important to note that the rules outlined below are not exhaustive but are intended to provide league members with a general indication of expected conduct.

- From the IFAB (Rules of Arbitration for Handball):
 - *What is considered a handball? If a player:*
 - deliberately touches the ball with their hand/arm, including moving the hand/arm towards the ball
 - scores in the opponents' goal directly from their hand/arm, even if accidental, including by the goalkeeper
 - after the ball has touched their or a team-mate's hand/arm, even if accidental, immediately scores in the opponents' goal
 - creates a goal-scoring opportunity
 - touches the ball with their hand/arm when the hand/arm has made their body unnaturally bigger
 - the hand/arm is above/beyond their shoulder level (unless the player deliberately plays the ball which then touches their hand/arm).
 - *What is not considered a handball:* Except for the above offences, it is not an offence if the ball touches a player's hand/arm:
 - directly from the player's own head or body (including the foot)
 - directly from the head or body (including the foot) of another player who is close
 - if the hand/arm is close to the body and does not make the body unnaturally bigger
 - when a player falls and the hand/arm is between the body and the ground to support the body, but not extended laterally or vertically away from the body

4.0 Games will consist of two x 22-minute (running-time) halves, with a short rest in between. There may be added time at the end of the halves at the discretion of the match official.

4.1 The second half may be adjusted to ensure the match ends at the allotted time.

4.2 The game is played with each side fielding six players and a keeper. If a team is not ready to commence play (with at least five players) within ten minutes of the scheduled start time, the opponent will be awarded a default win. Any team that is responsible for delaying the start of a match will have one point deducted from the league standings for each infraction.

4.4 There are no off-sides.

4.5 Substitutions may occur at any stoppage of play or “on the fly”. However, they must take place behind your own team’s goal or the outgoing player must first leave the field before the substitute may enter. Illegal substitutions (e.g. entering the field of play too soon, etc.) will result in a caution (yellow card) being issued to the person attempting to enter the game.

4.6 Following the scoring of a goal, no player shall take possession of the ball.

4.7 The official shall stop play when the ball is considered out of play or for an infraction. A change of possession will occur at the point of the infraction.

4.8 All fouls will result in a direct or indirect free kick. Opposing team players must remain at least six meters from the ball until it is in play. This includes goal kicks, corners, and free kicks.

4.9 Throw-Ins: The league will operate on kick ins when the ball is out of play. Therefore, there will be no throw ins in the game only kick ins.

4.10 Penalties will be awarded at the discretion of the referee for any fouls committed in the 'box'. The penalty is to be taken 7 meters from the goal line. All players must be behind the placement of the ball. The ball is considered 'live' following the attempt. This means the play will continue even in the event the shot is rebounded, saved, or deflected.

4.11 Handballs

From the IFAB (Rules of Arbitration for Handball):

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 - scores in the opponents’ goal directly from their hand/arm, even if accidental, including by the goalkeeper
 - after the ball has touched their or a team-mate’s hand/arm, even if accidental, immediately scores in the opponents’ goal
 - creates a goal-scoring opportunity
 - touches the ball with their hand/arm when the hand/arm has made their body unnaturally bigger
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 - directly from the player’s own head or body (including the foot)
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 - if the hand/arm is close to the body and does not make the body unnaturally bigger
 - when a player falls and the hand/arm is between the body and the ground to support the body, but not extended laterally or vertically away from the body

4.12 Over-time will only be used for playoff matches. It will consist of one, 10 minute, extra-time period. The extra-time period is sudden-death, and if the score remains tied at the conclusion of the extra-time period, then penalty kicks will follow to determine a winner. This is essentially the “golden goal” rule.

5.0 Fouls and Suspensions

5.1 Yellow and Red Cards

- If a player receives three yellow cards during the season, they will be suspended for one game.
- If a player receives a direct red card, the player must vacate the property of the field and the surrounding area. They can no longer watch or support their teammates, they must leave or security can be contacted.
- If a player receives a direct red card, the referee must write a match report for the League Management, who will then determine if the player should be suspended just one game, multiple games, or the rest of the season.
- **Players must give their name to the official when a card is given. If a player is ever found (during or after the match) to be falsifying their identity it will be considered a Major Incident and removed from the league with no reimbursement.**

5.2 With regards to indirect free kicks, direct free kicks and sanctions, rules are based on IFAB (via FIFA):
A direct free kick is awarded if a player commits any of the following offences against an opponent in a manner considered by the referee to be careless, reckless or using excessive force:

- charges
- jumps at
- kicks or attempts to kick
- pushes
- strikes or attempts to strike (including head-butt)
- slide tackles
- tackles or challenges
- trips or attempts to trip

If an offence involves contact, it is penalized by a direct free kick.

A player is considered Careless when they show a lack of attention or consideration when making a challenge or acts without precaution. No disciplinary sanction is needed.

A player is considered Reckless when they act with disregard to the danger to, or consequences for, an opponent and must be cautioned.

A player is considered to have used excessive force when they exceed the necessary use of force and/or endangers the safety of an opponent and must be sent off the field.

A direct free kick is awarded if a player commits any of the following offences:

- a handball offence (except for the goalkeeper within their penalty area)
- holds an opponent
- impedes an opponent with contact
- bites or spits at someone
- throws an object at the ball, an opponent or a match official, or makes contact with the ball with a held object

An indirect free kick is awarded if a player:

- plays in a dangerous manner, as deemed by the ref(s)
- impedes the progress of an opponent without any contact being made

- is guilty of dissent, using offensive, insulting or abusive language and/or gestures or other verbal offences
- prevents the goalkeeper from releasing the ball from the hands or kicks or attempts to kick the ball when the goalkeeper is in the process of releasing it
- commits any other offence, not mentioned in the Laws, for which play is stopped to caution or send off a player
- An indirect free kick is awarded if a goalkeeper, inside their penalty area, commits any of the following offences:
 - controls the ball with the hand/arm for more than six seconds before releasing it
 - touches the ball with the hand/arm after releasing it and before it has touched another player
 - touches the ball with the hand/arm, unless the goalkeeper has clearly kicked or attempted to kick the ball to release it into play, after:
 - it has been deliberately kicked to the goalkeeper by a team-mate
 - receiving it directly from a throw-in taken by a team-mate

5.3 Cautionable offences (yellow card)

A player is cautioned if guilty of:

- delaying the restart of play
- dissent by word or action
- entering, re-entering or deliberately leaving the field of play without the referee's permission
- failing to respect the required distance when play is restarted with a dropped ball, corner kick, free kick or throw-in
- persistent offences (no specific number or pattern of offences constitutes 'persistent')
- lack of sportsman-like behaviour
- entering the referee review area (RRA)
- excessively using the 'review' (TV screen) signal

A substitute or substituted player is cautioned if guilty of:

- delaying the restart of play
- dissent by word or action (arguing with the ref in a disrespectful manner)
- entering or re-entering the field of play without the referee's permission
- lack of sportsman-like behaviour

5.4 Sending-off offences (red card)

A player, substitute or substituted player who commits any of the following offences is sent off:

- denying the opposing team a goal or an obvious goal-scoring opportunity by a handball offence (except a goalkeeper within their penalty area)

- denying a goal or an obvious goal-scoring opportunity to an opponent whose overall movement is towards the offender's goal by an offence punishable by a free kick (unless as outlined below)
- serious foul play
- biting or spitting at someone
- violent conduct
- using offensive, insulting or abusive language and/or gestures
- receiving a second caution in the same match

If an offence involves contact, it is penalised by a direct free kick.

- A player is considered Careless when they show a lack of attention or consideration when making a challenge or acts without precaution. No disciplinary sanction is needed.
- A player is considered Reckless when they act with disregard to the danger to, or consequences for, an opponent and must be cautioned (yellow card).
- A player is considered to have used excessive force when they exceed the necessary use of force and/or endangers the safety of an opponent and must be sent off the field.

5.5 Suspensions

Any player receiving a second yellow card during a match will automatically receive a Red Card and will be removed from the game. Upon receipt of a red card, a player will automatically be suspended, as a minimum, for the next scheduled game. Additional suspension(s) will be made at the discretion of the League Management team. The player must leave the match immediately.

Players who incur suspensions will forfeit the right to play in all subsequent league games (all divisions), until their suspension is completely served in the division in which it was assessed, with no refunds issued.

6.0 Appeals

6.1 Players have a right to appeal any suspension greater than one game, and can do so by submitting an appeal email to camprec@concordia.ca.

6.2 Any harassment of a league official whether it is of a physical or verbal nature (threat), or any player that uses brutality, violent conduct, spitting, biting, serious foul play or abusive language, will be subject to the following conditions:

- 1) As a minimum, a one-year suspension from the date of the infraction for all Campus Recreation activities, with no refunds issued.
- 2) The suspended player must then re-apply for re-instatement (in writing) to the Manager, Campus Recreation after the termination of the suspension.

6.3 Any player who refuses to produce an I.D. card when requested by League officials will automatically be released from the league.

6.4 All captains' must disclose the contents of the waiver noted below to ALL players on their respective team prior to the start of the season and/or game in the case of spare players.

Agreement and waiver of liability

All team captains, leaders and/or other persons responsible for groups using Concordia University's Recreation and Athletics facilities are responsible for communicating the following important information to individual participants under their responsibility and/or supervision.

All participants recognize and accept that their participation in activities, offered or taking place on Concordia University's Recreation and Athletics facilities, including the programs, classes and equipment including but not limited to the Loyola Campus Arena, Stinger Dome, weight room, outdoor playing fields and gymnasium, is solely at the risk of each individual participant. All participants recognize and accept all liability for any injury, accident or loss of personal property and hereby release Concordia University, its agents, representatives and employees from all liabilities for any direct, special, incidental, consequential, punitive or exemplary damages, regardless of the form of action arising from or related to by our use of the facilities or our participation in the activities held in these facilities and/or offered by the facilities, except for claims or losses resulting from willful misconduct or gross negligence of Concordia University, its agents, representatives and employees. Participants must be in good physical condition and must have appropriate insurance coverage including medical coverage.

Participants agree to follow the facilities' instructional guidelines and to abide by all University policies and Codes, as applicable, regardless of whether or not they are members of the University community. Participants agree and accept that if they fail to abide by said University Policies and Codes as well as all applicable laws and regulations, their access to the facilities, equipment and/or participation in a program, if applicable, may be immediately cancelled and/or revoked and their access to the premises, use of the equipment and right to participate in a program in the future access, may be denied. All participants acknowledge that photos can be taken and used for communication and publications purposes for Concordia Recreation.

Please note the Recreation and Athletics Department reserves all rights to cancel or postpone any games in the event we have a schedule conflict. We will do our best to add games when possible. We make our best efforts to create well balanced schedules in regard to time of games for earlier or late games but we cannot ensure you will always play equal number of games; early or late.